

Microsoft to the rescue of iOS developers

For iOS developers who wish to develop apps for WP 7, Microsoft has come up with the iOS to WP 7 API mapping tool available at <http://bit.ly/eLYMTX>

History of email

Check out the history of the popular communication method called email <http://on.mash.to/igCOWz>

Distro hopping: pain free

Switch between distros without finding yourself in a mess!

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One thing which Linux and OSS enthusiasts are never tired of speaking is the word 'freedom'. Along with freedom, you also have a choice between 200 Linux distributions! However, if you're inclined towards changing distros (also known as 'distro hopping'), the one thing which you might have missed in a new installation each time is your home. We are not talking about bricks and walls but about your \$HOME directory. Here we show you the ways in which you will enjoy distro hopping and keep the things the way you like them!



If you have a separate /home partition, do not format it during installation

Method 1: With a separate /home partition

This works well if you have a separate /home partition. The procedure to install the new distribution in such a condition is quite easy. Before you begin the new installation process, open the /etc/passwd file and note the UID and GID of the user. Ensure you select advanced partitioning mode and mount the previous /home partition again as /home, but ask the installer not to format it.

Also, the username of the new user should be the same as that in the previous setting. This will make sure that the \$HOME directories will match. Also, make sure that the UID and GID of the new user being cre-

ated matches the UID and GID of the user on the previous installation. If the installer of the new distribution does not allow you to edit the UID and GID, leave them as they are.

After the installation finishes, your new distro would have the settings and files as had the previous one. However, if you were not able to change the UID and GID of the user, its best to first login as 'root' into the system in the first boot and run the command:

```
chown -R vaibhav /home/vaibhav
```

In the above command, we assume that the username (after installation) is 'vaibhav' and the home directory of the user is '/home/vaibhav'. To be on the safe side, you might like to change the owner group from

what it was to the primary group of the current user. For that, you must know the name of the primary group to which the user belongs. Run the command: `id vaibhav`

The output is as follows:

```
uid=500 (vaibhav)
gid=500 (vaibhav)
groups=500 (vaibhav)
```

Notice the part "gid=500 (vaibhav)". It tells that the numeric GID of the user 'vaibhav' is 500 and the name of the group is 'vaibhav'

(as well). Now, that you know the group to which the user belongs, you can run the command: `chgrp -R vaibhav /home/vaibhav`. This will set the owning group of all files and directories within /home/vaibhav to the current GID of the user and make sure that you do not have any permission problems. Log out of the root user and login with the username whose file ownership you have just changed. Once again, you might need to adjust appearance if the theme breaks.

Method 2: Without a separate /home

If you do not have a separate partition for the /home directory, things are a

bit tricky. All you have to do is to:

1. First, mount the root partition (/) of the previous installation.
2. Sometimes it can be done easily by clicking its shortcut in the file browser. If that does not work, you can use the following commands to mount /dev/sda1.

```
sudo mkdir /tmpmnt
sudo mount /dev/sda1 /tmpmnt
```
3. We assume that /dev/sda1 is your root partition, although you should check it on the previous distribution. If you do not know how to find which is your '/' partition for the installed Linux system, just open the terminal in the Linux distro currently installed and type the command:

```
mount | grep -i "/" type
```

 It should show something like:

```
/dev/sda1 on / type ext4 (rw)
```

 You can see the first part which says /dev/sda1. This is the partition where you have the root directory and has to be mounted during the installation.
4. Run the command `sudo nautilus` and navigate to /tmpmnt (press [Ctrl] + [L] and type in the address in the address bar). Now, go to /tmpmnt and remove all the directories from the partition, save the 'home' directory.
5. Now, unmount the partition by clicking the eject button (usually a triangle pointing upwards with a line below it) on the nautilus window. If you used the terminal to mount, use the command:

```
sudo umount /tmpmnt
```

 to unmount. Remember that the command is `umount`, not 'unmount'.
6. Now your partition is empty, except the home directory residing on it. It is precisely the condition as the previous one where you had a separate /home partition. You can now install the new distro on the same partition. The only thing you must take care